



# KNOWHOW?



**Q** I have been using Linux for the last several months. One day, while trying to delete files in a folder, I encountered the following error:

```
[root @ homeserver new] # rm -fr *
/bin/rm: Argument list too long.
```

I am aware that the folder contains around 3,000 files and is too big in size. Can you please give a solution to delete all the files in this folder?

—Nikhil Pandey,  
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From the error, it is very clear that the argument list is too long. One solution is not to try to 'delete all files' using a single command. It would be best to select a few files in one go and complete the deletion process in a few iterations. But if you must delete all the files in a single go, you need to run the following command:

```
ls | xargs rm -f
```

**Q** I have installed OpenSUSE 11.3 from the DVD that *LINUX For You* bundled with the magazine. It is working fine

on my Toshiba L310 laptop. I downloaded Skype 2.2 Beta for Linux (rpm file for OpenSUSE 11+), but was not successful in installing it. I tried using the following command to install it:

```
#rpm -ivh skype-2.2.0.35-suse.i586.rpm
```

...but it is resulting in the following error:

```
error: Failed dependencies:
    libpng12-0 is needed by skype-
    2.2.0.35-suse11.i586
```

—Saurabh Singh, saurav\_king11@yahoo.co.in

The error is due to a missing dependency. You need to install libpng12 by running the following code from the command line:

```
#zypper in libpng12-0-32bit
```

I have assumed you are connected to the Internet and the openSUSE repositories are active.

**Q** I am a PHP developer and have been using WAMP for development, for around one year. Recently, I decided to shift my development computer to Linux. As the first step, I decided to install Fedora 15 on my home computer. However, I encountered a few problems while installing the OS. When I try to boot my system using the Fedora DVD, it displays

a few lines of text/code and stops responding. What should I do? Please note that my systems configuration meets all the requirements stated in the installation guide of Fedora 15. It has an Intel Pentium IV, 3.0 GHz processor with 1 GB of RAM and 160 GB of HDD.

—Satya Prakash Madheshiya,  
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You have not provided us with the exact error message that you get when the system stops responding. I would suggest you watch the boot messages after you press 'Enter' to start booting. In the message, check whether the Linux kernel detects all your hardware or not. If you find that the installer does not properly do so, then you need to restart the installation using other boot options. Also, please do a media check to make sure that you do not have a defective DVD. To run 'media check' at the installation boot prompt, run the following command:

```
linux mediacheck
```

If the result of 'media check' is positive, I would suggest you try installing it in the text mode. Just type the following command and press 'Enter' at the installation boot prompt to start text mode installation.

```
linux text
```

Hope this addresses your installation issues. 